

Ruby Sanchez

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UX designer with a Cognitive Science and human-computer interaction background, passionate about pairing qualitative and quantitative research with hands-on design to make data platforms easier to navigate and understand. Directed cross-functional teams to turn ambiguous stakeholder needs into structured design decisions that move projects forward.

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Expected May 2028

Master of Information Management and Systems — Focus: HCI / UX Design

- Fall 2026 Coursework: Introduction to UX Design, Introduction to Programming & Computation, Introduction to Data Structures & Analytics, Information Organization & Retrieval, Leadership and Influence in Technology, Storytelling in UX

University of California, Santa Cruz

March 2026

B.S. Cognitive Science (Artificial Intelligence / Human-Computer Interaction) — GPA: 3.96

- Academic All-District Honors (2025, 2026), National Student-Athlete Honor Society Inaugural Class Inductee (2025)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX Design & Operations Director

Sep 2025 – June 2026

Tech4Good Lab

Santa Cruz, CA

- Designed an operational review template in Figma, defining metrics to systematically track the lab's overall health and yearly progress, that helped secure new grant funding through Baskin Engineering
- Redesigned the lab's onboarding and workflow system based on 1:1 stakeholder interviews, reducing member dropouts by 40%, eliminating late or incomplete weekly deliverables (previously ~25%), and improving grade averages from a B+ to an A average
- Stepped in and teamed with the lab manager to run lab operations during the lead faculty's sabbatical, coordinating check-ins across undergraduate, PhD, and MS students, and kept the lab fully operational for 3 months with little faculty oversight

Program Designer / Research Pathways Fellow

June 2025 – Sep 2025

Tech4Good Lab

Santa Cruz, CA

- Designed a structured literature review training workflow, using scaffolded templates such as summary worksheets and comparison tables, to help incoming researchers build competence and confidence in reading academic papers
- Piloted the program with new and returning lab members; reduced the need for one-on-one training and helped new members contribute to research discussions earlier, leading to lab-wide adoption for all ~30 incoming researchers every quarter

UX Design Intern

March 2025 – Dec 2025

DataShare Santa Cruz County

Santa Cruz, CA

- Conducted a content audit and competitor analysis to identify navigation confusion, such as a "Dashboard" link leading to a page titled "Community Health," then restructured labeling and menus through wireframing to reduce jargon and cognitive load
- Redesigned the landing page's visual hierarchy with a featured "Monthly Focus" tile and consolidated data dashboards for clearer readability
- Ran moderated usability testing with both new and returning users, using think-aloud and A/B comparison tasks; 70% preferred the redesign, and 83% of returning users favored it for its clarity
- Identified accessibility gaps in the redesign through testing, including font sizes below ADA standards and color-dependent indicators, and revised the design to fix them before launch, creating a more accessible experience for all users
- Presented research findings and design rationale to 12 DataShare committee members, justifying each key change and its impact on usability, resulting in stakeholder approval and site relaunch

UX Design Project Lead

Jan 2025 – June 2025

Tech4Good Lab

Santa Cruz, CA

- Directed a 4-person team through ideation and concept design for an AI-supported redesign of Compass, a previously published platform, aiming to expand access and enable more meaningful, flexible mentor-student communication
- Designed a Conversation Guide for mentors and a Dual-View interface for mentees, using AI to organize conversations into revisitatable, thematic groups so participants could stay engaged without needing to be present in real time
- Gathered feedback from the faculty advisor as a stand-in mentor user, uncovering his motivation to make every student feel prioritized, and shifted the design to address mentor needs alongside mentees'

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Team Captain, NCAA DIII Swim and Dive

Sep 2024 – June 2026

University of California, Santa Cruz

Santa Cruz, CA

- Strengthened team culture and coach-athlete communication across a 70-person team, resulting in the women's team's best finish in program history (2nd place) and the men's team's second conference championship title in program history
- Team Spirit Award (2022 - 2026), Teammate Award (2024, 2025), Heart of the Slug Award (2026), Team of the Year (2026)

SKILLS

Research & Design: Human-Centered Design, User Research, Usability Testing, A/B Testing, Information Architecture, Wireframing & Prototyping, Accessibility (ADA/WCAG), Requirements Gathering, Data-Driven Insights, Data Analysis & Visualization

Cross-Functional Collaboration: Stakeholder Communication, Project Scope & Coordination, Process Design, Team Leadership, Analytical Problem-Solving

Technical: Figma, HTML/CSS, Python, Jupyter, SPSS